



Magnavox Odyssey

Since it contained no processor or memory, there was no score keeping mechanism, or any way to save games. It used game cards that contained pin outs to change game settings, and were basically the power switch to operate the master unit.

One would think that the lack of audio capabilities and very basic black-and-white graphics were the leading cause for the lukewarm reception of the Odyssey; however, the general impression that the device only worked with Magnavox televisions was what contributed to the device's substandard performance in the market.

In 1972, Atari released an arcade version of Pong, which was basically a simulated table-tennis game, where you beat your opponent by earning a higher score. While the arcade version was a huge hit, Atari released a home version of Pong only in 1975, exclusively through Sears retail stores. It was also a commercial success and led to numerous clones. This version of Pong was the first to include an on-screen scoring system and sound effects, which set it apart from the crowd. Additionally, the partnership with Sears helped create the feel of a limited addition and generated more than enough buzz for the product; sales of more than 150,000 units in the holiday season and \$40 million dollars for Atari followed.

The game became Sears' most successful product at the time, spawning a whole generation of clones that attempted to capitalize on the home con-